Week 06 Knowledge Check — TPM Academy

Week 6 Knowledge Check — Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

> A short retention check covering the week's core ideas: stakeholder mapping (Power × Interest, RACI, watch lists), managing engagement, communicating technical trade-offs, AI-augmented meeting prep, and live negotiation. Answer each question, then check yourself against the key at the end. Aim for concepts, not trivia — every answer maps back to something we used in a lab.

Format: 12 questions (multiple choice + true/false). ~15 minutes. Individual or triad.

Questions

1. (MC) In the Power × Interest grid, which quadrant is called the "dangerous" or "surprise-veto" quadrant?

- A. High power, high interest
- B. Low power, high interest
- C. High power, low interest
- D. Low power, low interest

2. (MC) The RACI discipline for the five key decisions requires that each decision has:

- A. At least two Accountable owners, for redundancy
- B. Exactly one Accountable owner
- C. One Responsible and no Accountable
- D. The TPM as Accountable for every decision

3. (T/F) The org chart is a good enough starting point — a complete stakeholder map is essentially a copy of it.

4. (MC) Of the four engagement principles, which two are described as the *differentiators* (most TPMs do the other two by their second quarter in role)?

- A. Engage early + engage deliberately
- B. Match form to power + bidirectional asks
- C. Engage early + bidirectional asks

- D. One channel per stakeholder + engage early

5. (MC) Which quadrant do most rookie TPMs over-invest their attention in — because those stakeholders are easy to engage and ask for time?

- A. High power, high interest
- B. High power, low interest
- C. Low power, high interest
- D. Low power, low interest

6. (MC) “Match form to power” says a high-power, low-interest stakeholder should get:

- A. A crisp written update under ~250 words
- B. A weekly 30-minute sync
- C. A group email digest with the wider audience
- D. A quarterly newsletter

7. (MC) “Translating” a technical trade-off for a stakeholder primarily means:

- A. Using simpler, less technical words
- B. Re-framing it in the stakeholder’s currency — cost, customer outcome, regulatory exposure, velocity
- C. Removing the cost so the decision sounds positive
- D. Adding more architectural detail so they trust you

8. (T/F) When predicting the stakeholder’s top 5 questions for your 1-page brief, having all 5 come out friendly means the brief is well-prepared.

9. (MC) In the objection-map template, “the line we hold” should be:

- A. A general promise like “we’d compromise if needed”
- B. The smallest, specific ground you’d give up if the objection wins
- C. The list of everything you refuse to change
- D. The AI’s recommended response

10. (T/F) AI is a reliable source for telling you what has already been decided about your product, so you can skip validating its prior-context summary.

11. (MC) The negotiation “trade space” is the set of axes, at least one of which must be able to move. If nothing can move, then:

- A. You have maximum leverage
- B. You’re not negotiating — you’re just saying yes or no
- C. You should add more non-negotiables
- D. You’ve automatically found the trade space

12. (T/F) In the live negotiation rubric, “Held the line where it mattered” is the single highest-weighted dimension.

Answer Key

1. C — High power, low interest: the surprise-veto quadrant. They hand you a “no” at the worst time, so they go on the watch list with a named trigger.

2. B — Exactly one Accountable per decision. If two people are A, neither is; if no one is A, the decision rots.

3. False — Org chart ≠ stakeholder map. Walk the five circles; complete lists run 10–18 names, and the usual omissions (compliance, finance) are exactly who blindside you.

4. B — Match form to power + bidirectional asks are the differentiators. Engaging early and deliberately is table stakes most TPMs reach by quarter 2.

5. C — Low power, high interest. They’re comfortable to engage and they ask for your time — but the attention isn’t strategic.

6. A — A crisp written update under ~250 words. High-power gets crisp writing; high-interest gets conversation.

7. B — Re-frame it in the stakeholder’s currency. “Use simpler words” misses the point — CFO → cost, Customer Success → customer outcome, Compliance → regulatory exposure, Eng Director → velocity.

8. False — At least one predicted question should be hostile. If all 5 are friendly, you’re not stress-testing the brief.

9. B — The smallest specific ground you’d give up if the objection wins. It’s the senior-author signal — specific, not a vague “we’d compromise.”

10. False — AI does that poorly. It can re-organize what you give it, but it can’t tell you what’s been decided or verify facts against production. Every output gets validated — “looks fine” without opening the doc isn’t validation.

11. B — You’re not negotiating, you’re saying yes or no. The trade space is scope / time / quality-resources; offer movement on a different axis than the one they care most about.

12. False — “Held the line” is 15%. “Listened first,” “Translated tech to business,” and “Found the trade space” each carry 20% — listening and translating outweigh holding the line.